

FROM IDEA TO REALITY: An Unusual Journey

Have an idea that you want to implement? Hold on and read this article before you proceed any further. Your idea may be good but there are several other things you need to consider and do before you can ensure its proper implementation



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Innovation is one of the most used and abused term these days. But what exactly it means can be quite nebulous. When we talk about innovation, it can mean different things to different people.

For some, words such as original, unexpected, fresh have never been seen or thought of before. For others, it means challenging conventional notions of how things are done, bringing ideas from one industry to another, or from one geographic region to another.

We are trying to create meaningful points of difference for our products or services from current alternatives. Although it does not have to be always a product or service differentiation. It can also be about how they are processed, delivered, or managed.

However, one key issue often seen is that most people think innovation and creativity are interchangeable. It is only partly true. If I put it in the form of a formula, it will be:

$\text{Innovation} = \text{Creativity} + \text{Delivery}$

While creativity can be easy, delivery is where the challenges pop up the most. That is where the journey of idea to reality starts to falter.

There is more to creativity

Sometimes, it just takes one idea to solve a big problem. But being creative and producing new or different ideas is easy, especially if we compare that against being innovative and bringing ideas to life. Because innovation needs a lot more than just a bunch of ideas; only having ideas without doing anything with them is a total waste.

Being innovative means bringing ideas to life, scaling them up so that more people can benefit. It also means whatever you want to create must be useful, not just to one, two, or a few, but to many people. You must be able to produce or implement it at scale. And that needs a few additional steps.

During my days at Knewron Technologies, our customers always had ideas which they wanted to implement.

